



FINISHING AND STRIKING POWER · PRACTICAL GUIDE

+30 Workouts to Improve Shot Power and Accuracy

A complete bank of technique, applied strength and finishing-under-pressure routines, to turn chances into goals with more power and better aim.

Striking technique

Applied power

Accuracy under pressure

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The biomechanics of a powerful shot

A powerful shot isn't born only from the striking leg: it's the result of a chain of movements that starts at the plant foot and ends in the follow-through of the motion.



1. Plant foot

It is planted beside the ball, pointing toward the target: it sets the direction of the shot before the striking leg moves.



2. Hip and torso

The rotation of the hip and torso contributes the most power to the strike, more than the pure strength of the leg.



3. Locked ankle

A firm ankle at the moment of impact transfers the generated force without losing it at contact with the ball.



4. Follow-through

Finishing the motion forward, without stopping it, adds final speed to the ball at the instant of impact.



KEY TIP

Most amateur players lose power not from a lack of leg strength, but from a poorly placed plant foot or a torso that doesn't follow the rotation.



Power without losing accuracy

Hitting hard and hitting well are not opposing qualities: they are two skills trained together, always prioritizing technique before strength.

70%

OF A SHOT'S POWER COMES FROM THE
HIP AND TORSO, NOT JUST THE LEG

3 pillars

TECHNIQUE, APPLIED STRENGTH
AND REPETITION UNDER PRESSURE

Thousands

OF QUALITY REPETITIONS ARE WHAT
LOCK IN AN EFFICIENT TECHNICAL
MOVEMENT

THE ORDER OF PROGRESSION USED IN THIS EBOOK

1. Lock in striking technique with repetitions without pressure or fatigue (Block 1).
2. Add strength applied to the striking motion, in the gym and functionally (Block 2).
3. Add accuracy: turn power into finishing toward specific zones (Block 3).
4. Take everything to real game situations, with pressure, fatigue and opposition (Block 4).



KEY TIP

Never sacrifice technique for power: a technically poor but very strong shot is usually inaccurate. Win the movement first, then the strength.



How to use this routine bank

The 30 routines are designed to be worked 2-3 times per week, combining blocks according to the moment of your season.

BLOCK	WHEN TO PRIORITIZE IT
Striking technique	Preseason and any time as a weekly foundation
Shot power	2 times per week, on available gym days
Accuracy and finishing	After locking in technique, 1-2 times per week
Shooting in game situations	Close to competition, to transfer everything to the match

**WARNING**

The shot-power exercises include weighted lifts: if you're new to the gym, start with light loads and prioritize movement technique before progressing the weight.



BLOCK 1 OF 4

Striking technique

Eight routines to lock in the technical motion of the shot, without pressure or fatigue: the foundation for everything that follows.

8 routines · 15-20 minutes each

Priority: technique over power

With both legs



Striking technique

Lock in the technical striking motion without time pressure or fatigue.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Inside-of-the-foot strike into an empty goal	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Full-instep strike (controlled power)	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	First-time strike after a ground pass	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Strike from mid-range (18-20 m)	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Technical header on goal from crosses	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec



COACH'S TIP

Film yourself from the side and front at least once every two weeks: the camera doesn't lie about your technique.

LOG (DATE • LOAD/INTENSITY • RPE 1-10 • NOTES)



Striking technique

Repeat the same movement pattern until it becomes automatic.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Inside-of-the-foot strike into an empty goal	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Strike with the non-dominant leg	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Volley after a self-pass	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Cross-body finish from a tight angle	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Technical header on goal from crosses	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec



COACH'S TIP

Practice the same motion with both legs, even if one is clearly dominant.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Striking technique

Work on plant-foot placement as the starting point of every shot.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Full-instep strike (controlled power)	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	First-time strike after a ground pass	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Directed first touch + finish in two touches	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Cross-body finish from a tight angle	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Strike after controlling with your back to goal	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec



COACH'S TIP

The plant foot goes beside the ball, slightly behind, pointing toward the target.

LOG (DATE • LOAD/INTENSITY • RPE 1-10 • NOTES)



Striking technique

Add variety in contact surfaces (inside of foot, full instep, volley).

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Full-instep strike (controlled power)	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	First-time strike after a ground pass	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Cross-body finish from a tight angle	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Strike after controlling with your back to goal	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Technical header on goal from crosses	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec



COACH'S TIP

Keeping your eyes on the ball at the moment of contact matters more than it seems.

LOG (DATE • LOAD/INTENSITY • RPE 1-10 • NOTES)



Striking technique

Even out the technical level between both legs.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Full-instep strike (controlled power)	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	First-time strike after a ground pass	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Volley after a self-pass	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Strike after controlling with your back to goal	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Technical header on goal from crosses	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec



COACH'S TIP

Don't chase power yet in this block: prioritize the ball leaving with the correct contact surface.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Striking technique

Connect the previous control with the strike, without unnecessary pauses.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Inside-of-the-foot strike into an empty goal	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Strike from mid-range (18-20 m)	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Cross-body finish from a tight angle	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Strike after controlling with your back to goal	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Technical header on goal from crosses	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec



COACH'S TIP

10 quality repetitions are worth more than 30 rushed ones with no technical focus.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Striking technique

Film the motion to review the technique objectively.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Inside-of-the-foot strike into an empty goal	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	First-time strike after a ground pass	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Strike with the non-dominant leg	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Volley after a self-pass	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Strike after controlling with your back to goal	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec



COACH'S TIP

Rest enough between sets: technique degrades quickly with fatigue.

LOG (DATE • LOAD/INTENSITY • RPE 1-10 • NOTES)



Striking technique

Consolidate technique before adding strength or pressure in the upcoming blocks.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Full-instep strike (controlled power)	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Strike with the non-dominant leg	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Directed first touch + finish in two touches	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Volley after a self-pass	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec
	Cross-body finish from a tight angle	3	8-10 shots	60-90 sec



COACH'S TIP

Record how many shots in each set came out with the technique you were aiming for.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



BLOCK 2 OF 4

Shot power

Eight gym and functional strength routines, focused on the hip, torso and leg chain that gives the ball its speed.

8 routines · 30-40 minutes each

2 times per week recommended

Gradual load progression



Shot power

Develop explosive strength in the hip, posterior chain and core: the engine of a powerful shot.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Weighted jump squat	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Rotational medicine ball throw	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Weighted jump lunge	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Torso rotation with band (striking pattern)	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Explosive bench press (upper-body stability)	4	5-6 reps	2 min

**COACH'S TIP**

Shot power is built over weeks, not in a single session: be consistent with this block.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Shot power

Transfer gym strength to the rotation pattern you use when striking.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Single-leg Romanian deadlift (plant leg)	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Weighted jump lunge	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Torso rotation with band (striking pattern)	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Explosive hip extension on cable	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Explosive bench press (upper-body stability)	4	5-6 reps	2 min

**COACH'S TIP**

Progress the load only when you master the movement technique without compensations.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Shot power

Strengthen the plant leg, which stabilizes the whole motion.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Single-leg Romanian deadlift (plant leg)	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Weighted jump lunge	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Torso rotation with band (striking pattern)	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Explosive hip extension on cable	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Bulgarian split squat with dumbbells	4	5-6 reps	2 min



COACH'S TIP

The rotational medicine ball throw is the exercise that most resembles the real striking motion.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Shot power

Add upper-body power to sustain balance in aerial strikes.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Single-leg Romanian deadlift (plant leg)	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Weighted jump lunge	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Explosive hip extension on cable	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Bulgarian split squat with dumbbells	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Heavy kettlebell swing	4	5-6 reps	2 min



COACH'S TIP

Two sessions of this block per week are usually enough: it is highly demanding neuromuscular work.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Shot power

Train torso rotation with resistance, the same pattern as the strike.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Weighted jump squat	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Single-leg Romanian deadlift (plant leg)	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Rotational medicine ball throw	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Weighted jump lunge	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Torso rotation with band (striking pattern)	4	5-6 reps	2 min



COACH'S TIP

Take the full rest indicated: power is trained rested, not fatigued.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Shot power

Build a strength base that is later expressed as ball speed.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Weighted jump squat	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Rotational medicine ball throw	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Weighted jump lunge	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Bulgarian split squat with dumbbells	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Heavy kettlebell swing	4	5-6 reps	2 min



COACH'S TIP

Don't train shot power the day before a match: leave 48-72 hours in between.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Shot power

Progress the load gradually, week by week.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Single-leg Romanian deadlift (plant leg)	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Barbell hip thrust	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Rotational medicine ball throw	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Torso rotation with band (striking pattern)	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Explosive bench press (upper-body stability)	4	5-6 reps	2 min

**COACH'S TIP**

Always add a hip and core activation before this block.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Shot power

Combine gym and functional exercises for complete development.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Single-leg Romanian deadlift (plant leg)	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Weighted jump lunge	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Explosive bench press (upper-body stability)	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Bulgarian split squat with dumbbells	4	5-6 reps	2 min
	Heavy kettlebell swing	4	5-6 reps	2 min



COACH'S TIP

The plant leg takes as much load as the striking leg: don't neglect it.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



BLOCK 3 OF 4

Accuracy and finishing

Seven routines to turn power into goals: aiming at specific zones, with progressive difficulty.

7 routines • 15-20 minutes each

Measure your hit percentage

Both legs and header



Accuracy and finishing

Turn the power gained in the previous block into effective finishing.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Sequence of 10 shots at alternating zones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Shot under a cone barrier	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Finishing with a passive goalkeeper: choose the gap	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	First-time shot at a fixed target	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Header accuracy to marked zones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec



COACH'S TIP

Mark specific zones in the goal (with cones or tape) instead of just shooting "at goal" in general.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Accuracy and finishing

Train aiming at specific zones of the goal, not just "at goal".

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Shot at corners marked with cones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Mid-height finish, far post	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	First-time shot at a fixed target	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Header accuracy to marked zones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Finishing with a time limit (clock pressure)	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec



COACH'S TIP

Count your hit percentage in each set: it's the data point that will motivate you most to improve.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Accuracy and finishing

Add progressive difficulty: obstacles, tight angles and time limits.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Shot at corners marked with cones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Sequence of 10 shots at alternating zones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Shot under a cone barrier	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Finishing with a passive goalkeeper: choose the gap	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	First-time shot at a fixed target	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec



COACH'S TIP

Finishing to the far post tends to succeed more often than going for the goalkeeper's near post.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Accuracy and finishing

Work on deciding which zone to finish at, not just the execution.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Shot at corners marked with cones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Sequence of 10 shots at alternating zones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Shot under a cone barrier	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	First-time shot at a fixed target	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Header accuracy to marked zones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec



COACH'S TIP

Also practice finishing with the goalkeeper closing the angle: it completely changes the decision.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Accuracy and finishing

Consolidate accuracy with both legs and with the head.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Shot at corners marked with cones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Mid-height finish, far post	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Sequence of 10 shots at alternating zones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Finishing with a passive goalkeeper: choose the gap	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Finishing with a time limit (clock pressure)	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec



COACH'S TIP

The time limit simulates the real pressure of a play: don't skip it even if it's uncomfortable.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Accuracy and finishing

Simulate the pressure of finishing with few real chances.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Mid-height finish, far post	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Shot under a cone barrier	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Finishing with a passive goalkeeper: choose the gap	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	First-time shot at a fixed target	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Header accuracy to marked zones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec



COACH'S TIP

Accuracy under low fatigue first, under high fatigue only in Block 4.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Accuracy and finishing

Measure the hit percentage to see your progress week by week.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Shot at corners marked with cones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Mid-height finish, far post	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Sequence of 10 shots at alternating zones	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	Finishing with a passive goalkeeper: choose the gap	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec
	First-time shot at a fixed target	3	8-10 shots at target	60 sec



COACH'S TIP

Film your finishing sets to review where you tend to miss most often.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



BLOCK 4 OF 4

Shooting in game situations

Seven routines to finish under pressure, with opposition and fatigue: the final transfer to the real match.

7 routines · 20-25 minutes each

With an active defender or obstacle

Ideal close to competition



Shooting in game situations

Transfer technique, power and accuracy to real match contexts.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Shot after a directed first touch under pressure	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Running shot after a cross	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Header in contested aerial play	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	First-time shot after a low cross	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Finishing in fast transition (counterattack)	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min



COACH'S TIP

Always add an active defender or obstacle in this block: pressure completely changes the execution.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Shooting in game situations

Finish under the pressure of an active defender or goalkeeper.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Shot after a directed first touch under pressure	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	1v1 finish against the goalkeeper	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Finishing in fast transition (counterattack)	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Shot after a one-two with a teammate	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Finishing from outside the box, after a fatigue circuit	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min



COACH'S TIP

Practice finishing after a prior physical effort (sprint, jump): that's how you arrive most of the time in a real match.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Shooting in game situations

Sustain finishing quality even with accumulated fatigue.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Shot after a directed first touch under pressure	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	1v1 finish against the goalkeeper	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Running shot after a cross	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Header in contested aerial play	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Shot after a one-two with a teammate	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min



COACH'S TIP

In fast transition, the first decision (finish or pass) matters as much as the execution of the shot.

LOG (DATE • LOAD/INTENSITY • RPE 1-10 • NOTES)



Shooting in game situations

Train quick decision-making: which surface and which zone to use on each play.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Running shot after a cross	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Header in contested aerial play	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	First-time shot after a low cross	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Finishing in fast transition (counterattack)	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Finishing from outside the box, after a fatigue circuit	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min



COACH'S TIP

The header in contested aerial play also needs positioning work, not just jumping.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Shooting in game situations

Simulate the most frequent goal situations: crosses, counterattacks and one-tuos.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Shot after a directed first touch under pressure	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	1v1 finish against the goalkeeper	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	First-time shot after a low cross	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Shot after a one-two with a teammate	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Finishing from outside the box, after a fatigue circuit	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min



COACH'S TIP

Record your effectiveness in this block separately: it's the most faithful indicator of your real level.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Shooting in game situations

Close the full cycle: from isolated technique to finishing in real play.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Shot after a directed first touch under pressure	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	1v1 finish against the goalkeeper	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Running shot after a cross	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	First-time shot after a low cross	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Finishing in fast transition (counterattack)	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min



COACH'S TIP

If technique breaks down completely under pressure, go back one block and consolidate before continuing.

LOG (DATE • LOAD/INTENSITY • RPE 1-10 • NOTES)



Shooting in game situations

Assess your real effectiveness in match-like conditions.

	EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
	Shot after a directed first touch under pressure	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Running shot after a cross	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Header in contested aerial play	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Finishing in fast transition (counterattack)	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min
	Finishing from outside the box, after a fatigue circuit	3	6-8 repetitions of the action	90 sec - 2 min



COACH'S TIP

These routines are ideal for the last weeks before competition.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)

TO CLOSE

From technique to goal

Striking power isn't a talent you're born with: it's a technical skill supported by applied strength, trained through repetition and confirmed under real pressure. These 30 routines take you along that complete path.



Consolidate technique before chasing power.



Train shot power 2 times per week, with load progression.



Measure your accuracy percentage: it's the most objective way to see your progress.



Add pressure and fatigue only when technique is solid.



Work both legs and aerial play equally.



This material is for educational and general training purposes. If you have persistent joint or muscle discomfort, consult a health professional before continuing with the training plan.